A-A-51335
17 March 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SPATULA, LABORATORY
(Corrosion Resisting Steel)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification NNN-S-1356.

This commercial item description covers one type of laboratory spatula.

Salient characteristics:

Laboratory spatulas shall have the following characteristics as listed in Table I.

TABLE I Dimensions

		Materials of Construction		Blade		Overall
Type	Style	Blade	Handle	Wide (inches)	Length (inches)	Length (inches)
I	Narrow Tapered Flexible	Corrosion Resisting Steel	Wood	0.56	3 ± 1/8	6-3/8 ± 1/4
II	Double Blade Round End Square End	Corrosion Resisting Steel	Between Blades	0.313	1-7/8 ± 1/8	7 ± 1/4
III-A	Wide Blade	Corrosion Resisting Steel	Wood	0.75	4 ± 1/8	7-3/8 ± 1/4
III-B	Long Wide Blade	Corrosion Resisting Steel	Wood	1.25	8 ± 1/4	12-1/4 ± 1/4
III-C	Wide Blade	Corrosion Resisting Steel	Wood	0.62	3 ± 1/8	6-3/8 ± 1/4
IV	Round End Blade	Nickel-Copper Alloy or Corrosion Res. Steel	Wood, Cast Alum., Cor. Res. Steel	0.94	3-3/4 ± 1/4	7-1/4 ± 1/4

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

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Type I - Shall be a laboratory spatula suitable for handling materials which are to be weighed. Shall consist of a thin, flexible, tapered corrosion-resistant steel blade and a wooden handle. Shall have the nominal dimensions as listed in Table I.

Type II - Shall be a double ended semi-micro flat design spatula with one end round and one end square fabricated from corrosion-resisting steel. Shall be one piece construction having a minimum blade width of 1/4 inch and a maximum blade width of 3/8 inch. The blade shall be connected by a thin wire of the same material. Shall have the nominal dimensions as listed in Table I.

Type III-A - Shall be the wide blade spatula design fabricated of a suitable corrosion-resisting flexible steel with a wooden handle. Shall have the nominal dimensions as listed in Table I.

Type III-B - Shall be a long wide blade spatula design fabricated of a suitable corrosion-resisting flexible steel with a wooden handle. Shall have the nominal dimensions as listed in Table I.

Type III-C - Shall be a wide blade spatula design fabricated of a suitable corrosion-resisting flexible steel with a wooden handle. Shall have the nominal dimensions as listed in Table I.

Type IV - Shall be a wide blade spatula design having a rounded blade end fabricated of a suitable nickel-copper alloy or corrosion-resisting flexible steel with a wooden handle. Alternate materials for the handle shall be cast aluminum or corrosion-resisting steel. The blade shall have a cross section at its thickest edge of not less than 0.056 inches. Shall have the nominal dimensions as listed in Table I.

Blades - Spatula blades listed in Table I shall be in conformance with the following requirements as applicable. Nickel-copper alloy blades shall be in conformance with ASTM Standard E-75 or B-122. All blades shall have a #8 mirror finish and uniform construction. Blades shall have a Rockwell hardness of C 40 to C 50 when tested in accordance with ASTM Standard E-18. Blades shall be flexible and shall not break, show signs of fatigue or corrosion under laboratory use. Each blade shall have minimum cross section at its thickest point of 0.040 inches unless otherwise noted. This measurement does not include the tang or portion of the blade encompassed by the handle material.

Handles - The handle of the spatula shall be secured to the tang portion of the blade by at least two corrosion-resisting rivets. These rivets shall be flush with or slightly below the finish of the handle and shall fully support the blade. The handles shall be durable, smoothly finished and fabricated of one of the following hardwoods: beechwood, rosewood, cocobola or walnut. The handle shall be square cut and tapered or rounded and tapered on the ends. Wood handles shall have a high finish and be uniform in construction. Aluminum or corrosion-resisting steel handles shall be uniform in construction and be proportional in size to a wooden handle. All handles shall afford a comfortable and efficient grip. Each spatula shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturers name or registered trademark.

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Laboratory spatulas shall withstand repeated normal cleaning cycles and show no sign of deterioration or deformation of materials. Lot sizes shall be uniform in all characteristics and materials of construction for each type of spatula. Spatulas shall have none of the following which shall be considered defects.

Cracks in wood or alloy handles
Sharp edges, burrs, chips, scratches
Missing components
Non uniform appearance
Deformation of materials

Workmanship. The laboratory spatulas shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One spatula of the type specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspections. Inspections, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more inspection characteristics. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level S-2, AQL 2.5, and sampling for tests (when applicable) shall be conducted at inspection level S-1, AQL 1.0.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6640-00-975-0453	SPATULA, LABORATORY, Type I
6640-00-264-5032	SPATULA, LABORATORY, Type II
6640-00-171-5198	SPATULA, LABORATORY, Type III-A
6640-00-439-7375	SPATULA, LABORATORY, Type III-B
6640-00-439-7350	SPATULA, LABORATORY, Type III-C
6640-00-556-9000	SPATULA, LABORATORY, Type IV

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION A-A-51335

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

CIVILIAN COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Project No. 6640-1368

Location: S3-9-18

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